



IIT ROORKEE



NPTEL ONLINE
CERTIFICATION COURSE

Public Speaking

Lecture 11: Cultural Awareness in Public Speaking

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What is Culture?

- ❖ “Culture is a code we learn and share, and learning and sharing require communication. Communication requires coding and symbols that must be learnt and shared.”
- (Alfred G. Smith, Preface to *Communication and Culture*)
- ❖ Symbols, rituals, values and heroes (Geert Hofstede)
- ❖ To understand a culture one needs to understand things as language and gestures, personal appearance, social relationships, religion, philosophy and values, family customs, education and communication systems.

In China, children adore Mu Lan, a woman of 6th century for her filial devotion.

“Language and Culture are frameworks through which humans experience, communicate, and understand reality”
(Lev Vygotsky, 1968).



Talking through Cultural Differences

- Public speaking across different cultures is essentially about recognizing and respecting cultural differences.
- The differences shall encompass both demographic factors such as age, gender, race, ethnicity, ability, language, economic and social status.

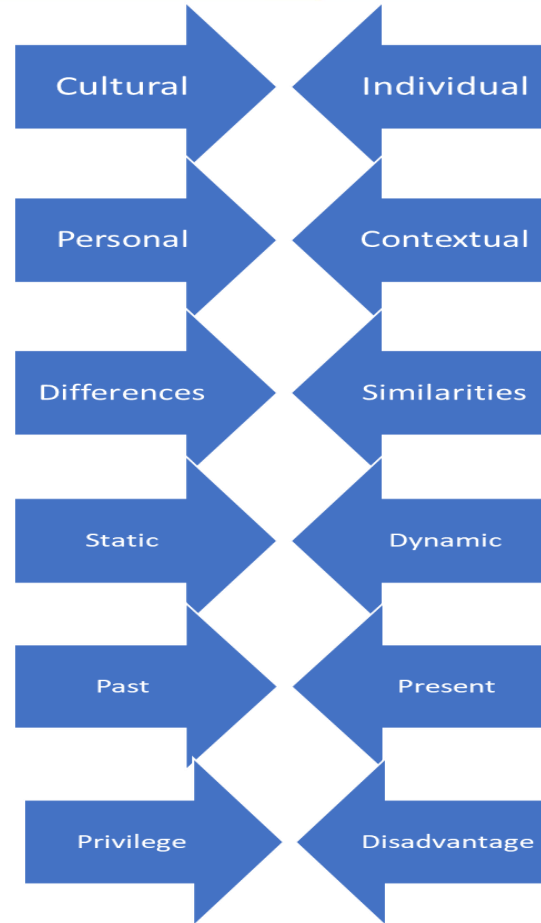


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Intercultural Communication

- Scholars like Martin and Nakayama (2010) called intercultural communication as a dialectic approach.
- Both the speaker and the listener try to participate in an interaction, irrespective of their cultural differences, and learn something new.
- It is in between this interactive experience that the sharing of minds and culture occurs.
- Public speaking provides space for a dialectic flux to happen which shall eventually lead to a better understanding of oneself, others and the world in general.

Dialectics of Intercultural Communication (Martin & Nakayama, 2010)



Cultural Intelligence

- The term “Cultural Intelligence” was coined in the year 2003 by theorists namely Christopher Early and Soon Ang.
- It is also known in other synonymous terms such as Cultural Quotient (CQ) and Cultural Competence.
- The idea of cultural intelligence to a public speaker relies upon his/her ability to communicate and convey the chosen message with intended effect to a multicultural audience.
- Audience group on the receiving end will usually display heterogeneity of cultures and languages.
- Thus, a good public speaker has to be culturally aware and competent.

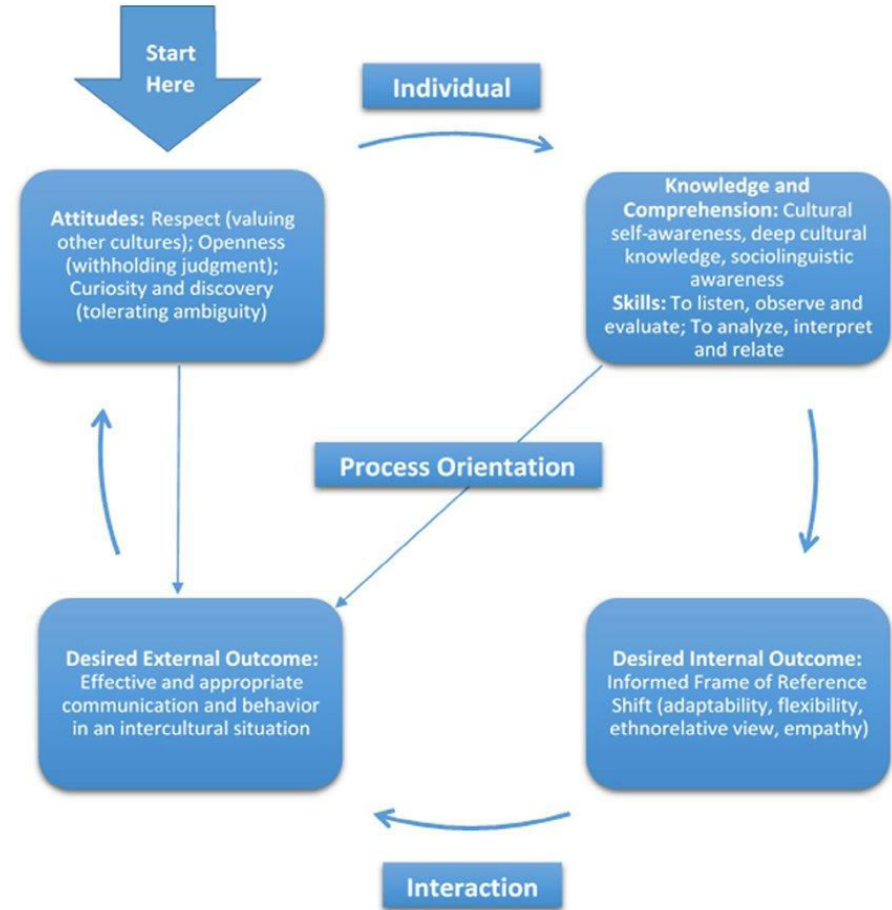
How to Achieve Cultural Competence?

- Cultural competence is not a goal to achieve but only a process to carry on and grow.
- An experienced public speaker would require pertinent practice and continuous exercise.
- Qualities like open-mindedness and respect for other cultures shall set grounds for a speaker to be culturally competent.
- Deardorff's model (2004) of intercultural competence illustrates on how acquiring cultural intelligence and awareness is a cyclical process.

Deardorff's Model of Intercultural Competence

It comprises five important elements:

1. Attitudes
2. Knowledge
3. Skills
4. Internal Outcomes
5. External Outcomes





Public Speaking and Multiculturalism

As how interpersonal communication sets platform for exchange of ideas, intercultural communication acts as a passage for cultural awareness.

A public speaker shall understand more about himself and his verbal qualities better as s/he gets acquainted with different cultures.

Cultures can be studied better through interactions than observation.

Culture and communication are intertwined (McLean 2005).

Connect the Cultural Gap

- Assess the speech response through direct and indirect feedback you receive from the other end.
- Rectify the strength of communication based upon the received feedback.
- “Cultural codes” act as the key to unlock and connect the gap between the speaker and audience.
- Public speaking rehearsals and a research outlook of the place of presentation would help at best.
- Urge to know (curiosity) and to learn (knowledge) can guide speaker to receive and process cultural feedback far efficiently.



Bridging Cultural Gap in Business

- When speaking in a national or global workspace, a public speaker must ensure to undertake **formal tone** at all costs.
- Be concise and straightforward as much possible.
- Stick to the literal meanings of the words uttered.
- Learn few foreign phrases with respect to the diversity of colleagues for interaction and greeting purposes.
- Listen actively. Reply back in a self-composed manner.



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Bridging Cultural Gap in Classroom

- The aim of public speaking in a classroom set-up is to build a fine rapport between students and teachers.
- Public speaking shall enable a sense of community in the classroom.
- It also acts as a channel for not just teachers but also for students to express themselves freely.
- With a better interaction between students and teachers, the classroom becomes a more inclusive space for diversity of individuals to thrive and grow together.



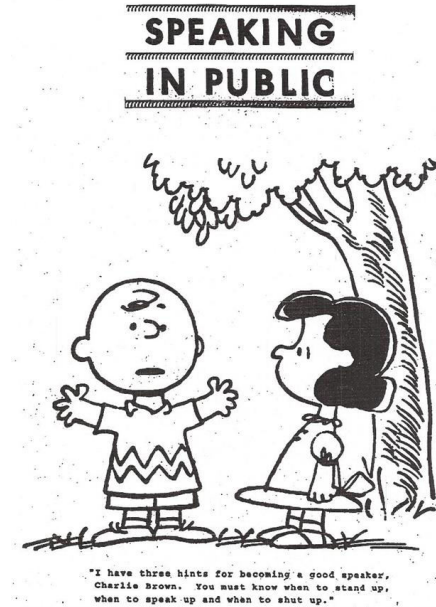
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Evaluating Audience Learning Preferences

- A speaker should afford to put themselves in the shoes of listeners before final presentation.
- With sufficient knowledge gained through audience analysis, the speaker shall figure out the learning preferences of audience.
- **Learning preference** of audience indicates the preferred medium through which audience would like to process information and understand.
- Depending on which, a speaker shall use **aural, visual or theoretical support** to connect and convey effectively.

Use of Humor in Multicultural Setup

- Humor is a double-edged sword when it comes to public speaking.
- In a pluralistic setup, a public speaker is bound to exercise more caution.
- Chances are high that the audience may not get the joke or misunderstand the applied sense of humor.
- The linguistic pluralism should be checked. Usage of British and American English should be moderated according to the type of audience.
- The content prepared as slides or graphic support should be ensured to not contain anything offensive.



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Check Cultural Bias

- Cultural bias is a two-way barrier when it comes for a speaker to address a diverse audience group.
- First, it is the cultural bias that stays with the speaker.
- The second type exists amongst the audience group, collectively or individually.
- Former kind of bias can be checked and eliminated through research and practice on the given topic.
- While the latter can be regulated by establishing a clear understanding of the cultural context of topic and audience addressed.

Cultural Caution in Public Speaking

- With all learning experience and knowledge brought forward by a cultural cluster of audience, it also raises concerns to be taken care of for a smooth communication process.
- Every public speaker must prepare themselves on the following criteria before confronting an intercultural room of audience.
 - ✓ Style and Directedness (High context cultures vs Low context cultures)
 - ✓ High Context Cultures. e.g. Japan - focus on politeness and subtlety.
 - ✓ Low Context Cultures. e.g. Germany - direct and straightforward.
 - ✓ Individualism Versus Collectivism
 - ✓ External Appearance (in terms with the place of presentation)
 - ✓ Eye contact.

How High and Low Context Cultures differ?

- ❑ High context culture (Japan, China and Arab countries)
 - ✓ Intuitive, contemplative, stress on non-verbals, meaning to physical and social setting
- ❑ Low context culture (North America, Scandinavia, France and Germany)
 - ✓ Logical, analytical and action oriented.
 - ✓ Values individualism

Some Instances of Cultural Differences

❑ Superstitions

❖ In Mexico

Saloon where people gather to drink pulque, a distillate of cactus, is considered good fortune to get worms in your cup

❖ In Japan

Maneki neko (beckoning cat)

❖ In China

Phonetic sound of 8 is most fortuitous of numbers auguring prosperity

❖ Hong Kong

A license plate with eight number is quite valuable
4 can be read as shi , a homophone for death.



Contd...

- ❖ Red is a symbol for Christian charity and for Communism and class conflict.
- ❖ Latin Americans do not stick to time.
- ❖ Mourning is symbolized by yellow in Philippines.
- ❖ It's impolite to offer gifts to a man's wife in Arab.
- ❖ Failure to make an anytime visit in India is an insult.

Overcoming Cultural Differences

- Appreciation and tolerance
- Respect other cultures the same as yours
- Prefer Commonalities to differences
- Use of unbiased language
- Empathy and adaptability

**“Culture is the widening of the mind and
of the spirit.”**

– Jawaharlal Nehru

Thank You

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Lecture 12: Breaking the Ice: Impress to Express

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First Impression: Why is it important?

“You never get a second chance to make a first impression.”

AND

“A good first impression can work wonders.”

- J. K. Rowling

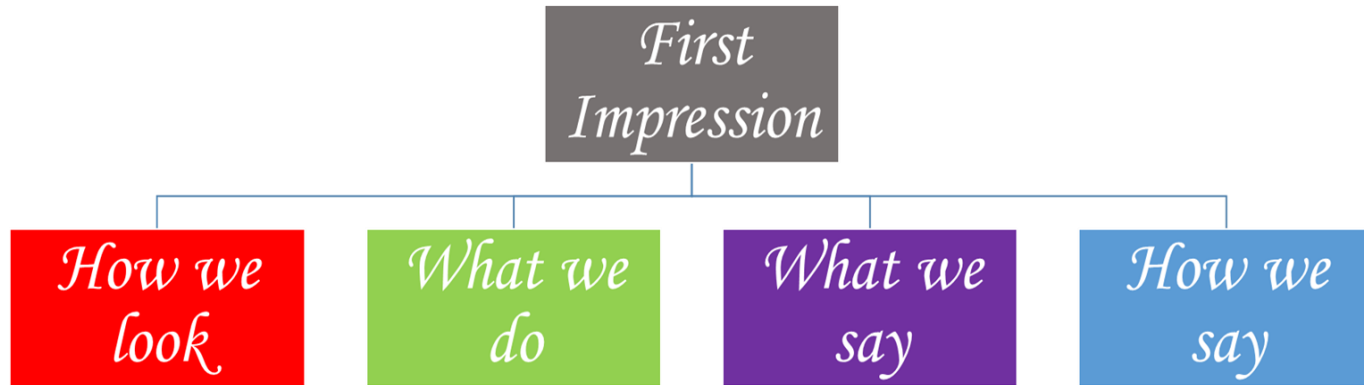


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First Impression in Public Speaking

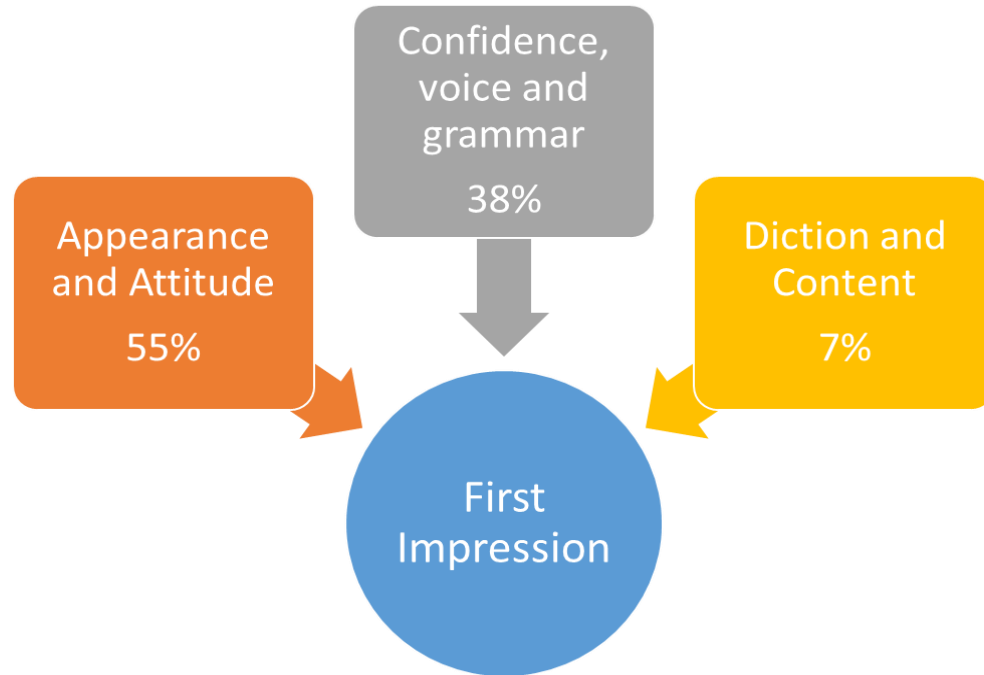
- ❑ First Impression plays a crucial role in the personal, social and professional development of an individual.
- ❑ Chinese thinker, Sun Tzu says: “**Every battle is won or lost before it is ever fought**”. The skill of casting a good first impression offers an advantageous position to a speaker - the attention and credibility of the audience is mostly won over much before the speech has begun.
- ❑ As public speaking is a special skill in the contemporary world, and making a good first impression happens to be a vital component of it, therefore it can be established that the duo are the building blocks of the road to success - personally and professionally.
- ❑ **Fact check:** In a survey of 2,000 hiring managers, 33% claimed to know whether or not they would be hiring a candidate in less than 30 seconds! **First Impression Matters!!!**

Factors Influencing First Impression



- ❑ **How We Look:** Align your appearance with the image you want to portray and the message you want to deliver. Right from personal appearance - clothing, hair, shoes - to the slides, flyers, brochures and handouts, all of it ought to appear engaging and fascinating to the audience.
- ❑ **What We Do:** Make choices in real life consistent with what you speak in public. Lead by examples and actions.
- ❑ **What We Say:** Verbals and non-verbals both hold equal significance in creating a strong first impression. Make lucid, smart and professional statements. Curate your speech carefully focused on the audience and the occasion. Communicate using a jargon-less, intelligible and appropriate diction.
- ❑ **How We Say:** Speak with confidence in your tone. Wear a smile on your face. Refine your pronunciation. Keep your conversational pace suited to the comprehensive ability of your audience.

First Impression: Building Blocks



First Impression with the Audience: Tips for Pre-Performance

- ❑ **Groom Up:** Choose a comfortable and decent outfit suited to the occasion and keep a tidy appearance.
- ❑ **Create a Comfortable Ambience:** Check for a pleasant and comfortable setup of the venue -
 - ❑ Lighting
 - ❑ Microphone
 - ❑ Seating arrangement
 - ❑ Background music
 - ❑ Technological aids

- ❑ **Plan your Speech:** Research about your audience. Plan your speech beforehand; highlight the key messages; define your objectives, prepare a strong beginning and a memorable ending.
- ❑ **Practise Communication Skills** - Work on your vocabulary and articulation. Practise your speech in front of a mirror or your friends and work on the feedback. Keep it natural.
- ❑ **Scheme a Strategic Pre-Event Promotion:** Market your speech and your ideas ahead of the event through social media tools like Facebook, Twitter hashtags and online campaigning.
- ❑ **Arrange for takeaways:** Target to achieve a lingering effect on your audience by providing them with catchy takeaways - summary brochures, CDs/DVDs pertaining to the message of your speech.

First Impressions: Common Slips

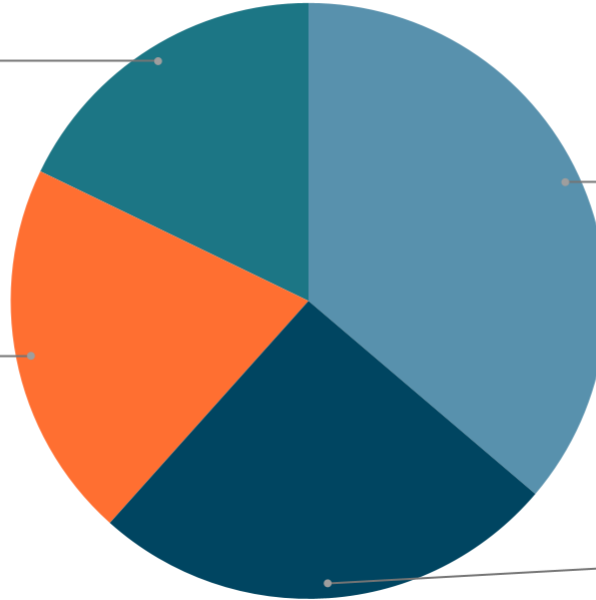
Points scored

Bad Posture
17.8%

Expressionless Face
20.5%

Fail to make Eye
36.2%

Poor Knowledge
25.4%



CARNEGIE'S 6 RULES

1. BE GENUINELY INTERESTED



2. SMILE



3. USE THEIR NAME



4. LISTEN



5. TALK IN TERMS OF THEIR INTEREST



6. MAKE THEM FEEL IMPORTANT



First Impression with the Audience: Tips for Delivery Day

☐ **Be on Time:**

- ☐ Plan to arrive a few minutes early.
- ☐ Allow room for delays in traffic.
- ☐ Check the ambience and tech connections beforehand.

☐ **Positive and Confident Body Language:**

- ☐ Check your Posture
- ☐ Relax your facial muscles
- ☐ Wear a smile
- ☐ Make eye contact

❑ Give a Strong and Riveting Opening:

“Blackshirts of revolution, men and women of all Italy, Italians all over the world, beyond the mountains, beyond the seas, listen. A solemn hour is about to strike in the history of the country. Twenty million Italians are at this moment gathered in the squares of Italy. It is the greatest demonstration that human history records. Twenty millions, one heart alone, one will, one decision.”
(Mussolini)

- ❑ Prepare the 60-90 seconds talk to hook your audience and relax yourself into speech.
- ❑ Don't start with self-introduction.
- ❑ Introduce your topic through an engaging talk.
- ❑ Direct questions can be catchy openers - *“How many times have you...? Or, “Raise your hand if...”*.
- ❑ Openings can also be humorous in a tell-tale manner - *“I’ll never forget the day when...”*.
- ❑ A bold or shocking statement also works its part to give audience a reason to put down their mobile phones and pull out their notepads.

- ❑ **Demonstrate Cultural Sensitivity:**
Communicate ideas in a language sensitive to gender and culture.
- ❑ **Be Polite and Courteous:** Put forward your arguments with decorum.
- ❑ **Encourage Audience Participation :**
Make your speech more inclusive by a two-way exchange.
- ❑ **Respond to Questions Gracefully**
- ❑ **Tailor your Tone:** Use your voice to your best advantage.
- ❑ **Be Authentic:** Project the best version of yourself, but the genuine one!

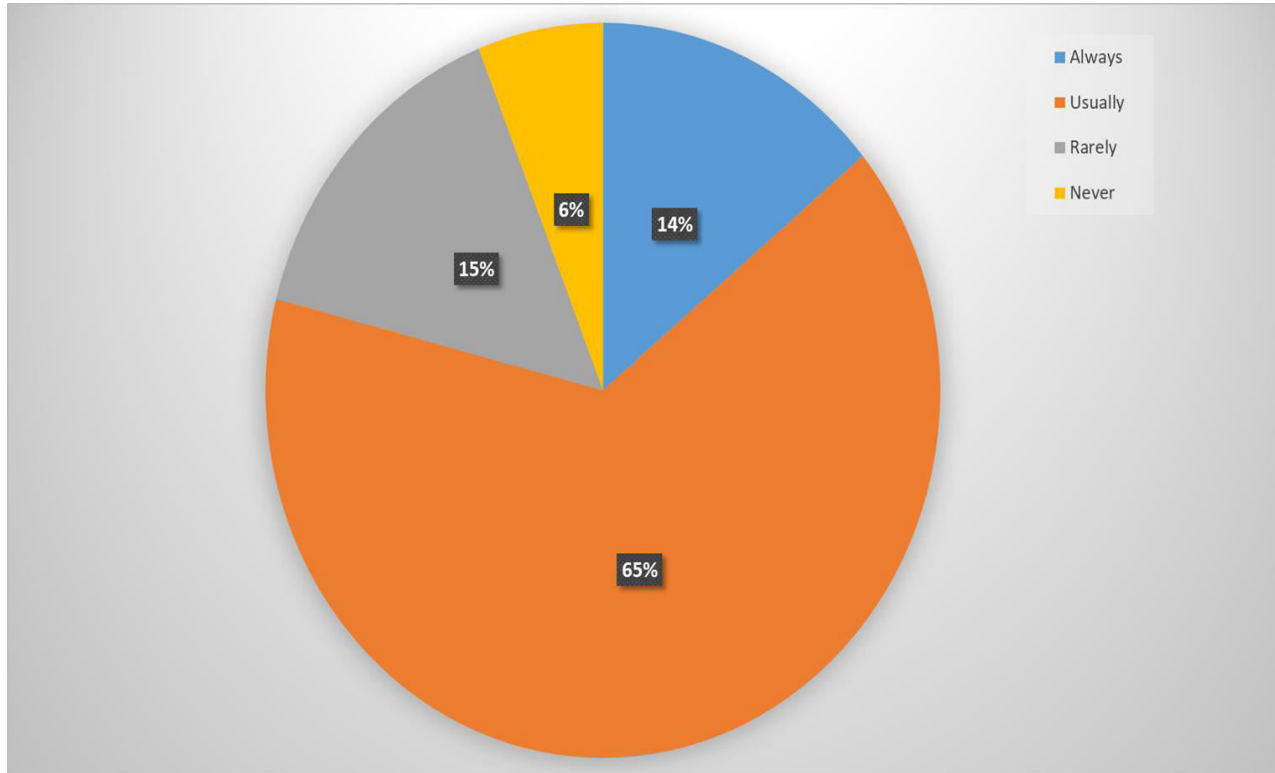


Being Heard and Cheered by your Audience

- Greet your audience cheerfully.
- Establish a cordial rapport.
- Address the audience on a personal level.
- Channel your talk so as to make your listeners feel important.

Having Audience Sleep through your Presentation

- Keep your audience waiting.
- Mumble or speak falteringly..
- Encumber your speech with '*ums*' and '*ahs*'.
- Read out to your audience in a monotonous voice.



As per survey reports, the above pie chart shows the percentage of people who believe they make a good first impression.

Things to remember

- Avoid opening your talk with a humorous story.
- Begin your talk on a cordial note.
- Audience are interested in your talk and not apologies.
- Create curiosity.
- Open your talk with story/question/anecdote/quote.
- Avoid opening your talk too formally.
- Audience hear what they expect to hear.

“Tell them what you’re going to tell them, then tell them, then tell them that you’ve told them.”

- Hillaire Belloc

First Impression Lasts!



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Thank You!

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Public Speaking

Lecture 13: Glossophobia

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Glossophobia: Is it for real?

- ❑ Glossophobia (the Greek γλῶσσα *glossa*, meaning tongue, and φόβος *phobos*, fear or dread) refers to the fear of public speaking. It is an anxiety disorder, a phobia characterized by constant and extreme fear of a situation or an object.
- ❑ Individuals suffering from glossophobia experience fear and anxiety while speaking in front of a group of people.
- ❑ As a result, they avoid speaking in public. Fear of rejection dominates their every public interaction.
- ❑ Over time, this may result negative impacts on their mental health and efficiency.



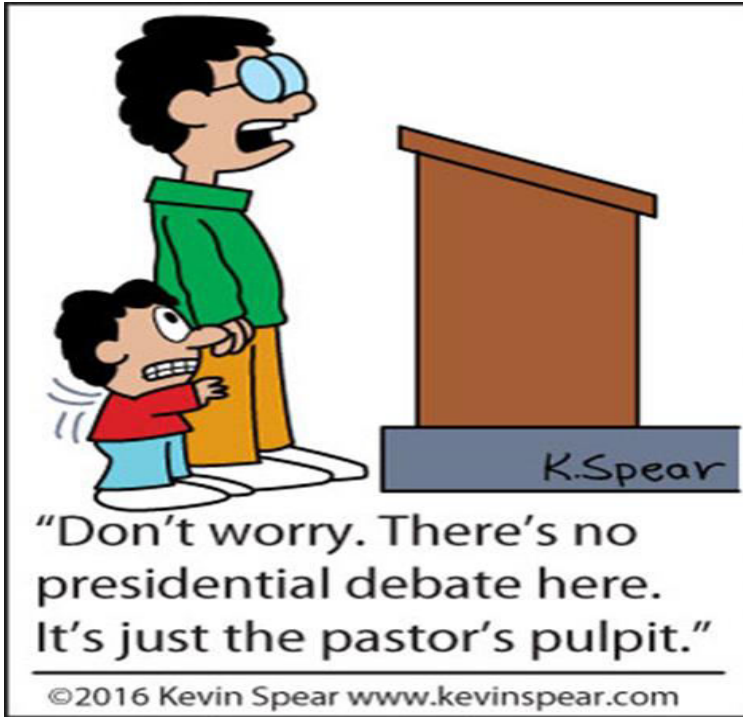
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Symptoms of Glossophobia



"I believe that I shall never be old enough to speak without embarrassment when I have nothing to say."
-Lincoln

Glossophobia: Its Range and Reach



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- Glossophobia is a common form of anxiety.
- More than 75% of population have this form of anxiety.
- This anxiety can range from slight nervousness to paralysing fear and panic attacks.

"He who fears death will never act as becomes a living man". – Seneca

Diagnosing Glossophobia

- ❑ People suffering from glossophobia may show the following indications while preparing for public speaking:
 - Faltering with Words
 - Indecisive about Content
 - Unfamiliarity with the Receiver
 - Unfamiliarity with the Situation
 - Poor Listening
 - Emotional instability



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According to Mulac and Sherman, there are four elements in speech fright:



Anxiety Behaviours (Mulac and Sherman)

Voice

- Tense Voice
- Too fast
- Too slow
- Monotonous: lack of emphasis

Verbal Fluency

- Nonfluencies: stammering
- Vocalized pauses
- Hunts for words: speech blocks

Mouth and Throat

- Swallows
- Clears Throat
- Breathes Heavily

Facial Expression

- Lack of Eye contact
- Tense face muscles
- Deadpan facial expression

Arms and Hands

- Rigid or tense
- Fidgeting
- Motionless

Gross Bodily Movements

- Sways
- Paces
- Shuffles feet

Flight-or-Fight Reaction

People who suffer from glossophobia experience flight-or-fight reaction because of the adrenaline produced in human body. It is a primitive response that still exists in our body. Once conquered, one can overcome the fear of public speaking.

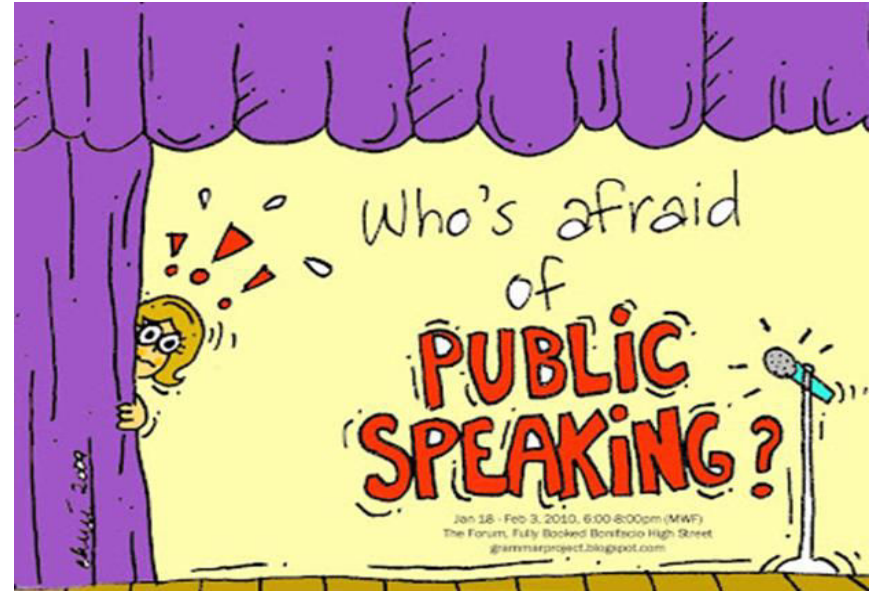


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Famous Public Orators with Glossophobia

❑ Some of the famous people with Glossophobia are:

- Renée Zellweger
- Nicole Kidman
- Abraham Lincoln
- Mahatma Gandhi
- Sigmund Freud
- Thomas Jefferson



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A Psychologist's Observation

“Our natural survival devices take over to prepare us for an emergency. Our muscles tense for better agility, our heartbeat and breaths quicken to provide large supplies of fuel, our glands secrete fluids to sharpen our senses and give us emergency energy.”

-William James

Anxiety (also called solicitude) is a psychological and physiological state characterized by cognitive, somatic, emotional, and behavioral components. These components combine to create an unpleasant feeling that is typically associated with uneasiness, fear or worry.

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How to overcome Glossophobia?

Preparation and Persistence are immensely locomotive in overcoming glossophobia.



There are several steps that one can follow in order to overcome glossophobia:

❑ **Know your topic:**

A better understanding of the content of speech can do wonders. The more an individual familiarises with the topic, the chances are lesser to be derailed from the topic altogether.

❑ **Get organized:** One should always strive to stay ahead of time and carefully plan the information to be shared, the props and the audio-visual aids required. An outline of the complete interaction should be pictured and jotted down.

☐ **Practice alone can make you perfect**

- ✓ Practice is the key for overcoming glossophobia. If possible, one can always seek for honest feedback from people whom one can trust initially. Later, one can present in front of lesser-known crowd. Recording oneself while presenting can be extremely helpful for improvement while watching the video.

☐ **Challenge specific worries**

- ✓ Making a list of all the specific worries can really help an individual. One can then directly challenge them by identifying probable outcomes and working accordingly.

Visualize success

- ✓ One has to imagine that the presentation will go well. Law of attraction is for real and positive thoughts can decrease some negativity about social performance and relieve some anxiety.

Do some deep breathing exercises

- ✓ This can be very claming in maximum cases. Taking two or more deep, slow breaths repeatedly can ease the strain. One should definitely do this before reaching the podium or entering a conference room for presentation.

☐ **Focus on material, not on the audience**

- ✓ Audiences tend to pay attention to novel information more than how it is being presented. They may or may not notice the nervousness. It is true one has to speak to the audience but content is the kingdom one needs to stay loyal to as well.

☐ **Do not fear moments of silence**

- ✓ One might lose track of what one is saying or begin to feel nervous or mind might run blank, the silence that follows seems eternal but it's not. It is probably for only a few seconds. Even if it is longer, it is likely that audience won't mind a pause to consider what is being talked of. Remember to take slow and deep breaths when that happens.

Recognize success

- ✓ After the presentation, speech, or any act of public speaking, one needs to appreciate oneself. The delivery may or may not have been perfect, but an individual is likely to be more critical of oneself than the audience. Reach out and find whether your worries occurred in actuality. Everyone makes mistakes and there is always room for improvisation.

Get support

- ✓ Join groups that offer help. One can seek professional help if the fear is not being overcome by these practices. Never shy away from help, it only makes an individual stronger.

**“Decide that you want it more than you are afraid
of it.” -Bill Cosby**

Thank You

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Lecture 14: Emotional Intelligence

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DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



Emotion

“... the bodily changes follow directly the perception of the exciting fact, and that our feeling of the same changes as they occur is the emotion”(William James, p. 449).

Emotional Intelligence

Emotional Intelligence is “the capacity to reason about emotions, and of emotions to enhance thinking. It includes the abilities to accurately perceive emotions, to access and generate emotions so as to assist thought, to understand emotions and emotional knowledge, and to reflectively regulate emotions so as to promote emotional and intellectual growth” (Mayer, Salovey & Caruso, 2004, p. 197).

Four Branch Model

- ❖ Perceiving Emotion : Non-verbal perception
- ❖ Using Emotions to Facilitate Thought: Creativity
- ❖ Understanding Emotions: Proper Treatment/Action
- ❖ Managing Emotions: Promote goals

(Mayer & Salovey, 1997)

Speech Fright

- As already mentioned in the previous lecture, fear of public speaking is real and can be conquered with the tools of practice and persistence.
- Audience never view one's fright as seriously as the individual - meaning that one does not sound as bad as s/he does in her/his head.



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Factors Causing Speech Fright

- ☐ Less engagement with platform speaking activity
- ☐ Minimal or no participation in extracurricular activities and social activities
- ☐ Difficulties in making social adjustments
- ☐ Incompetent linguistic ability
- ☐ Less interested in involving oneself into verbal self-expression

De-sensitization is Essential

According to Ross, “the desensitization approach has proved effective with the typical temporary public speaking form of fright. Desensitization has been defined as a form of emotional re-education involving deep relaxation” (Ross 101).



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Need of Emotional Intelligence



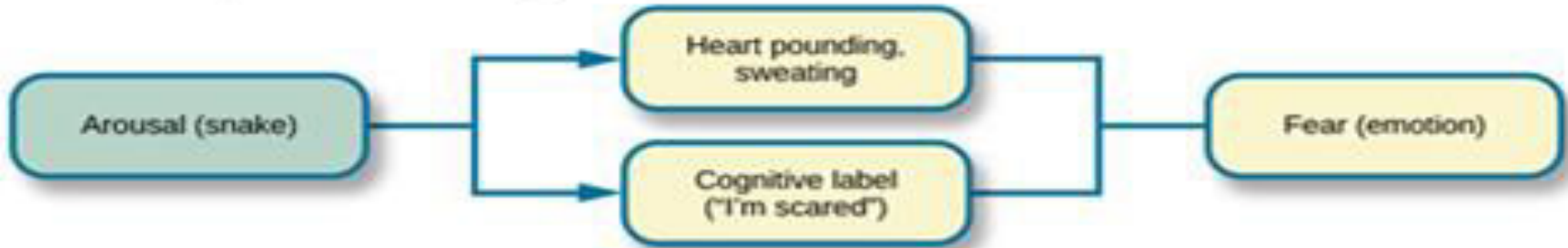
- The need of Emotional Intelligence arises out of the limitations of Intelligence Quotient.
- Public speakers would attribute emotional intelligence as a prime reason behind their success than to their IQ.
- Anyone shall collect and study data for creating content for public speaking. But, it takes EI to effectively carry out the prepared content.
- Studies suggest that “**IQ—had zero or negative correlation** with the [participants] eventual career success.”

Some Facts about Emotional State

- An emotional state may be considered as a function of a state of physiological 'arousal' and of a cognition appropriate to this arousal.
- Cognition determines physical arousal labelled as anger, joy, fear or whatever.

Theories of Emotion

Schachter-Singer Two-Factor Theory



Lazarus' Cognitive-mediational Theory

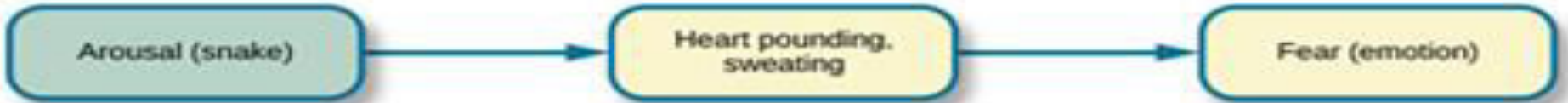




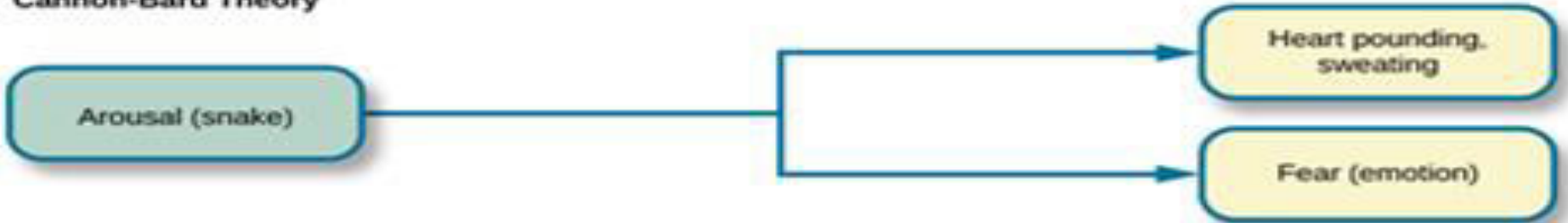
Time

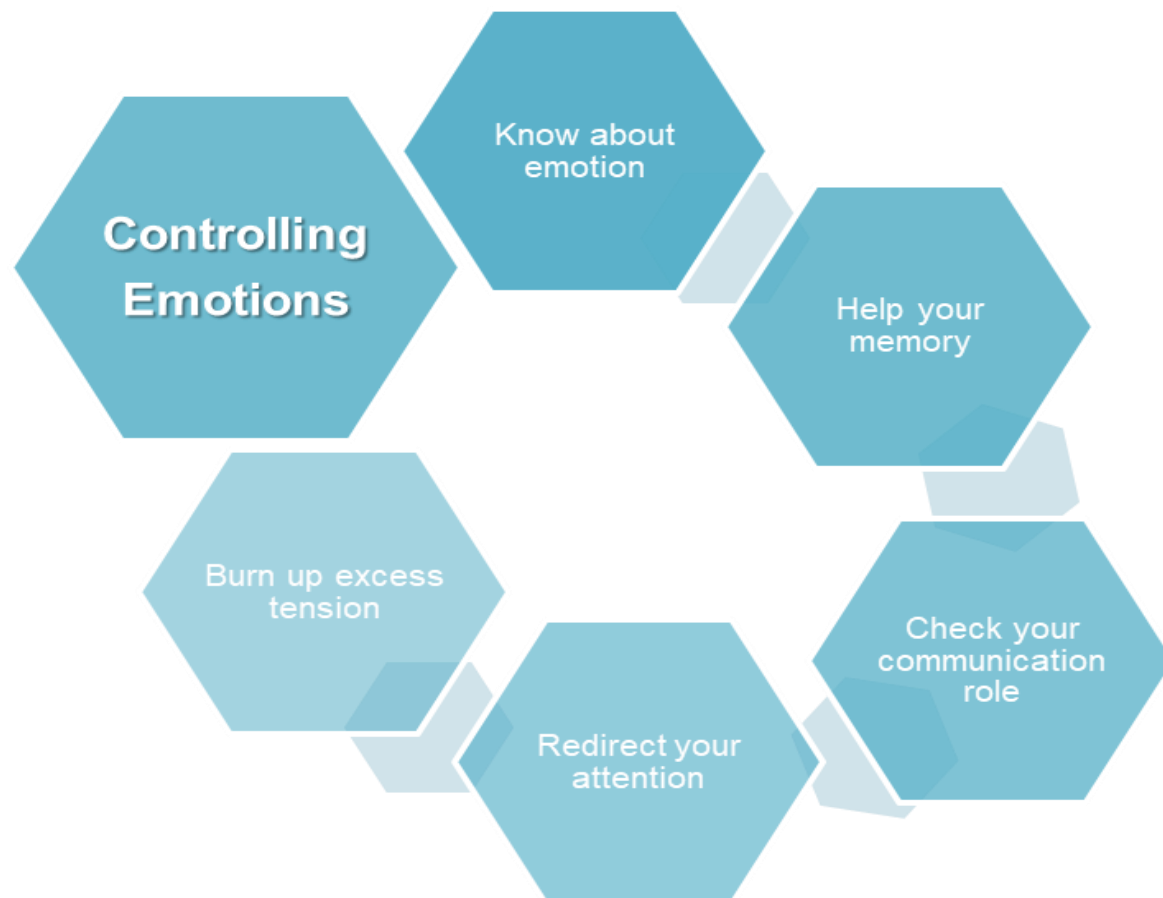


James-Lange Theory

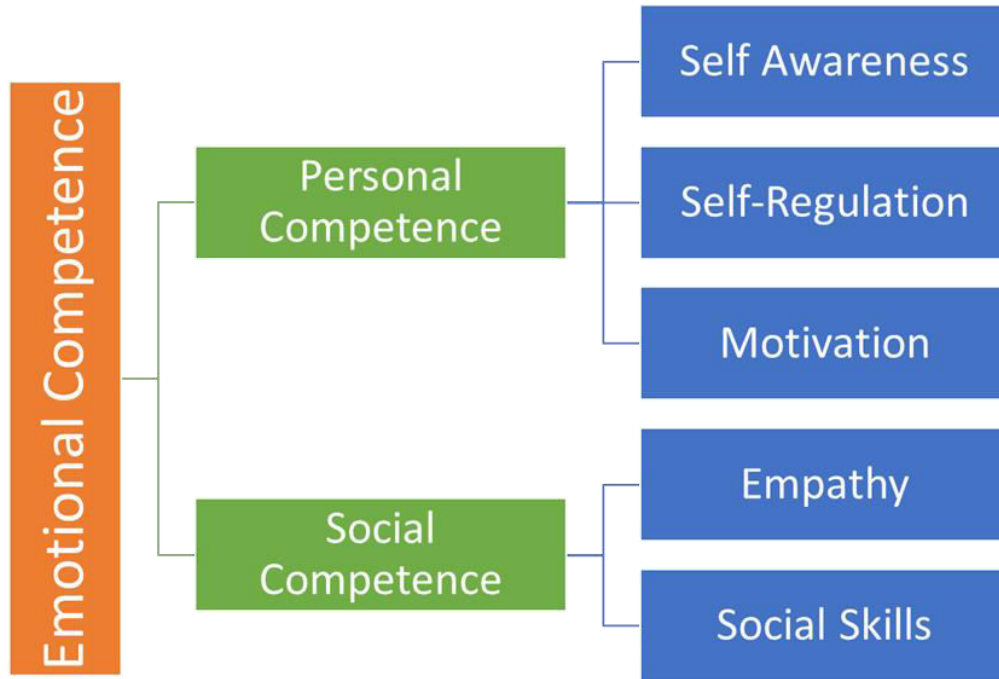


Cannon-Bard Theory





Goleman's Emotional Competence Framework



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Personal Competence

Self Awareness

- Developing Emotional Awareness.
- Able to Self Asses.
- Develop Self Confidence.

Self Regulation

- Keeping Calm.
- Be Conscientious of your performance
- Adapt quickly to unforeseen changes.
- Bring Innovation.

Motivation

- Drive to impact/ influence.
- Speak for a cause – a goal or an initiative.

Social Competence

Empathy

- Understanding listener's need and expectations.
- Prove to be mutually beneficial.
- Answer responsibly and politely to the feedback and queries.
- Political awareness –power hierarchy in listener group.

Social Skills

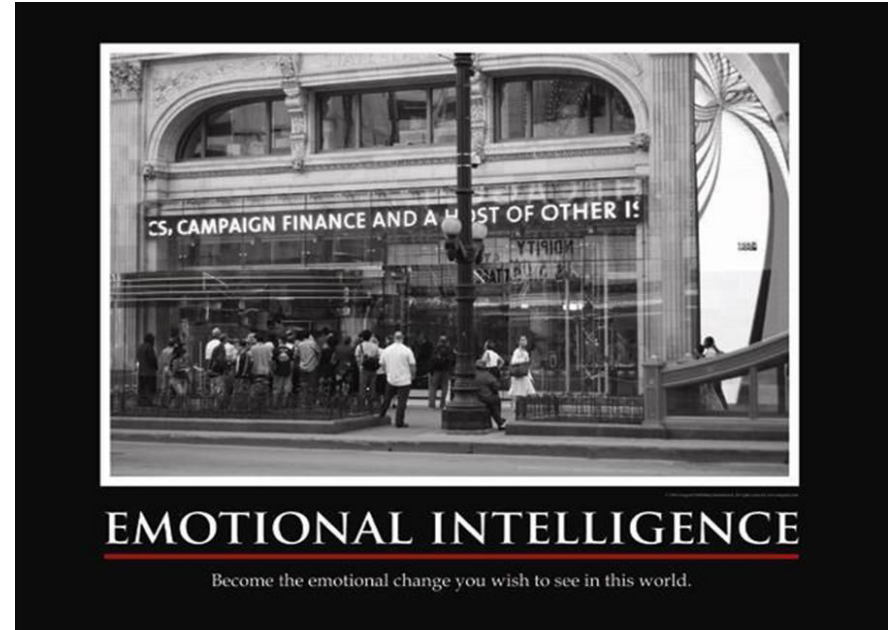
- Be an effective influencer.
- Active listening.
- Conflict Management.
- Leadership skills.

Practices for Emotional Intelligence

1. Strategic Planning
 - a. Research, Rehearse and Anticipate response.
2. Emotional Literacy
 - a. Channel your emotions into concrete words.
3. Recognize pattern
 - a. Understanding one's choice of words, repetitions and pattern.
4. Motivate yourself
 - a. Inspire yourself. Work for a greater cause – a long-term goal.
 - b. Inspire others.

Advantages of Emotional Intelligence

- Healthier personal well-being
- Clarity in communication makes one a better influencer.
- Better decision-making ability
- Self-motivated
- Lesser emotional stress and anxiety issues



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Gains of High EI

“The high EI individual, most centrally, can better perceive emotions, use them in thought, understand their meanings, and manage emotions, than others. **Solving emotional problems** likely requires less cognitive effort for this individual. The person also tends to be somewhat **higher in verbal, social, and other intelligences**, particularly if the individual scored higher in the understanding emotions portion of EI. The individual tends to be more open and agreeable than others. The high EI person is drawn to occupations involving **social interactions such as teaching and counseling** more so than to occupations involving clerical or administrative tasks.”

“The high EI individual, relative to others, is less apt to engage in problem behaviors, and avoids self-destructive, negative behaviors such as smoking, excessive drinking, drug abuse, or violent episodes with others. The high EI person is more likely to have **possessions of sentimental attachment** around the home and to have more **positive social interactions**, particularly if the individual scored highly on emotional management. Such individuals may also be more adept at describing motivational goals, aims, and missions.”

(Mayer, Salovey, & Caruso, 2004, p. 210)

Tips for Emotional Regulation

Understand
emotion

Utilize tension
before speech
situation

Redirect
attention to
pleasant
emotions

Protect your
memory through
logical systems
of organization

Evaluate
communication
role and situation

Concentrate on
message more
than yourself

“It takes something more than intelligence to act intelligently”
- Fyodor Dostoyevsky

Thank You

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Public Speaking

Lecture 15: Role of Positivity in Public Speaking

Prof. Binod Mishra

DEPARTMENT OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES



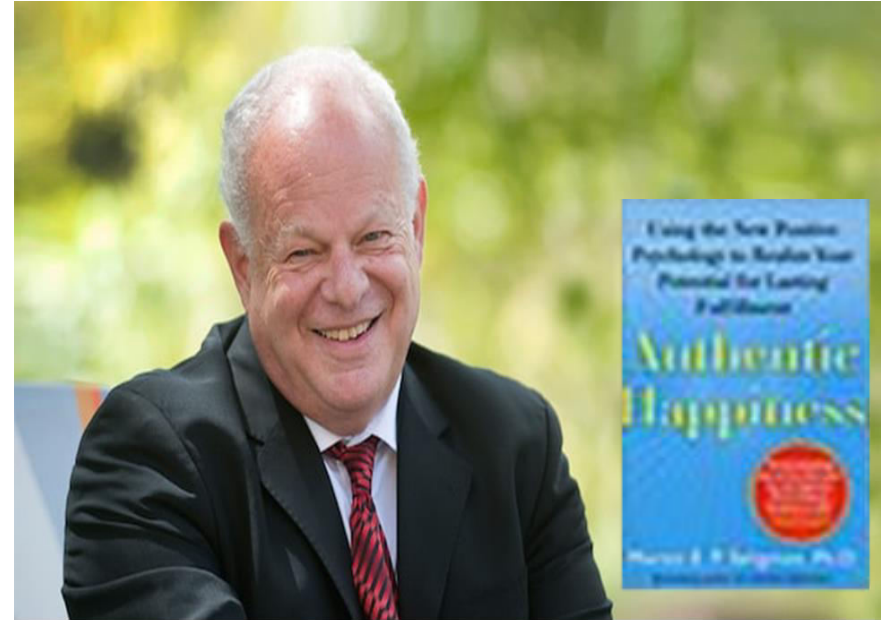
Defining Positive Thinking

“Positive thinking is a positive mental attitude that firmly believes that things will soon be better and with that belief, one can overcome any type of difficulty in his favor.”

- Norman Vincent Peale

Positive Psychology

- Propounded by **Martin Seligman**
- *“Positive psychology is the scientific study of what makes life most worth living”* (Peterson, 2008).
- Positive psychology focuses on strengths instead of weaknesses.
- The prime focus of positive psychology is on character strengths, optimism, well-being, self-esteem, self-confidence, gratitude, hope and compassion.



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Positive Attitude

- ***“People may hear your words, but they feel your attitude.” – John C. Maxwell***
- In any form of communication, the speaker should connect with the audience on multiple levels - linguistic, paralinguistic, non-verbal - in order to deliver the intended meaning.
- Attitude plays an important role in establishing communication.
- Positive attitude can act like a catalyst in achieving desired outcomes.

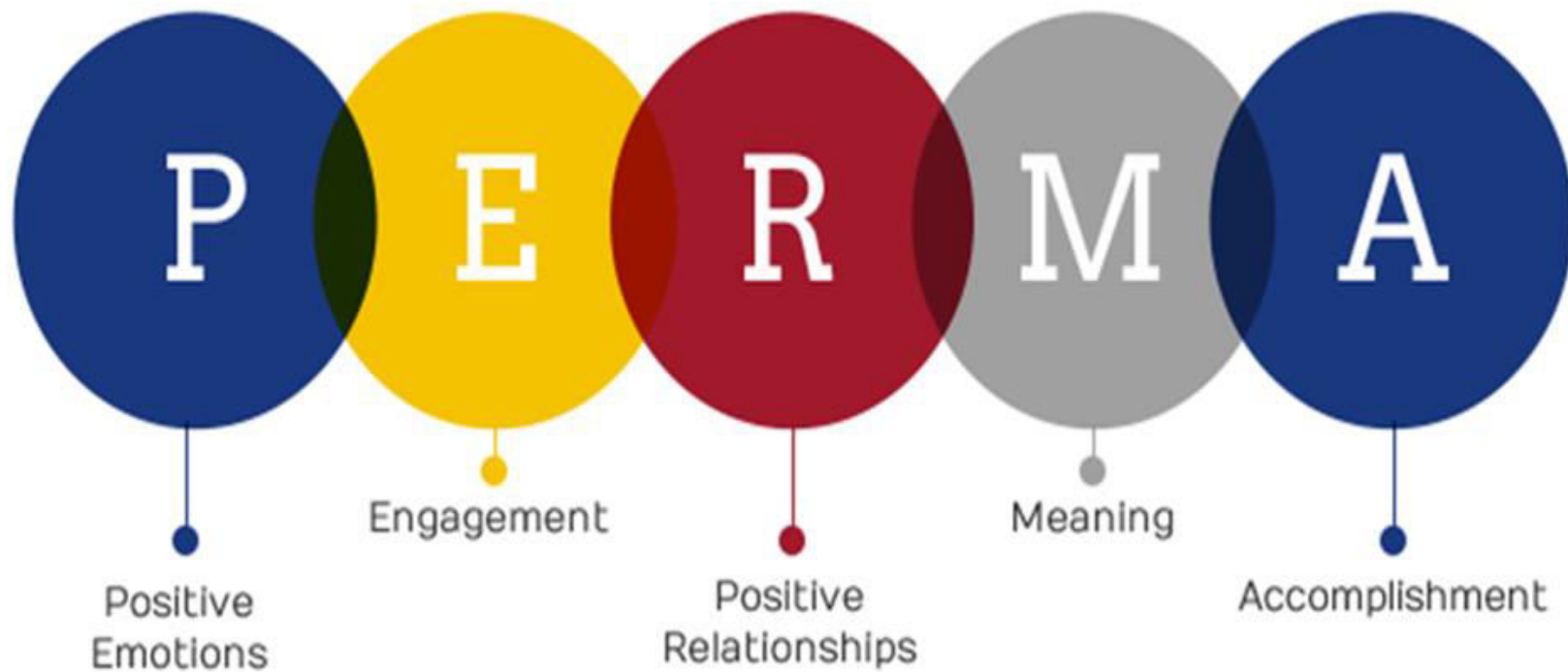
“There is nothing either good or bad,
but thinking makes it so.”
- Rosencrantz from Hamlet

Three Types of Happiness	Examples	Causes
Life Satisfaction	• I think my life is great • I am satisfied with my job	• A good income • Achieving one's goals • High self-esteem
Positive Feelings	• Enjoying life • Loving others	• Supportive friends • Interesting work • Extroverted personality
Low Negative Feelings	• Few chronic worries • Rarely sad or angry	• Low neuroticism • One's goals are in harmony • A positive outlook

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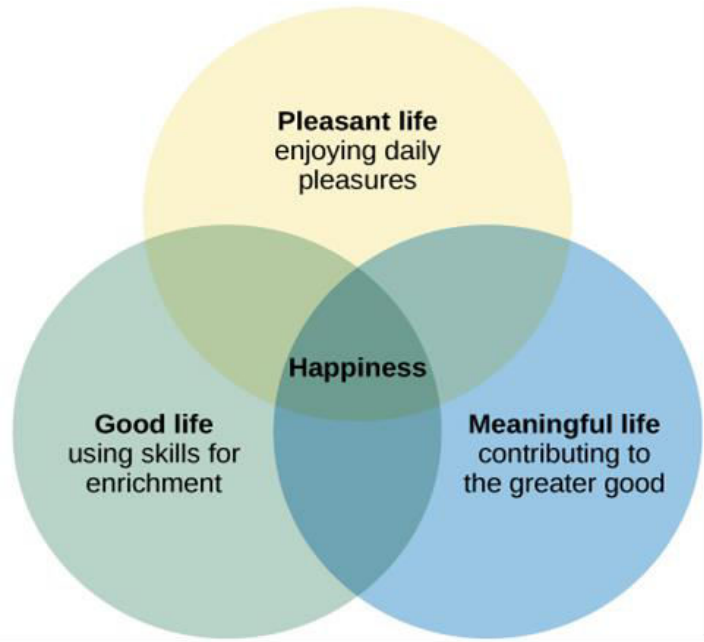
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- “Positive psychology takes you through the countryside of pleasure and gratification, up into the high country of strength and virtue, and finally to the peaks of lasting fulfillment, meaning and purpose” (Seligman).
- **PERMA** is an acronym devised by Martin Seligman which refers to the components of “good life.”



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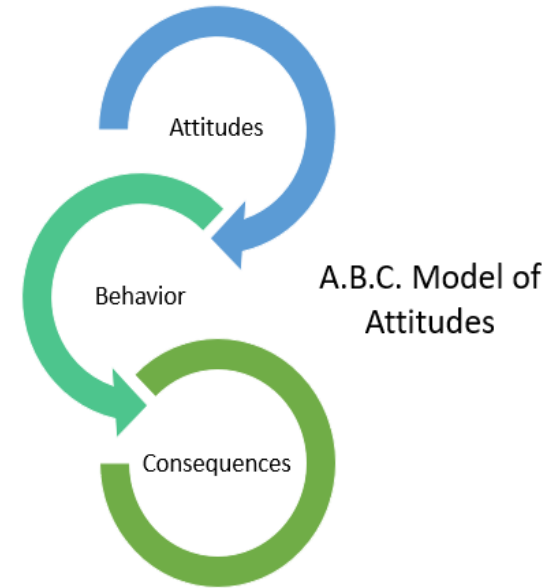
Impacts of Positive Psychology



- ❖ Positive emotions boost confidence and drastically improve our job performance.
- ❖ It is contagious in any given situation.
- ❖ Simple actions impact happiness.
- ❖ Positive emotions increase the chances of success.

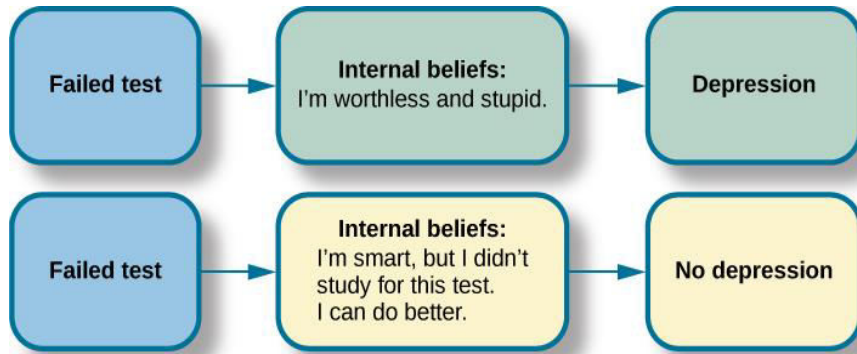
ABC Model of Communication Attitude

- The ABC model was first formulated by American psychologist, Albert Ellis.
- The model was a part of Rational-Emotive Therapy (RET) and Cognitive-Behavioral Therapy (CBT).
- The acronym stands for its three key components:
 - Attitudes/ Affect
 - Belief/ Behavior
 - Consequences/ Cognition

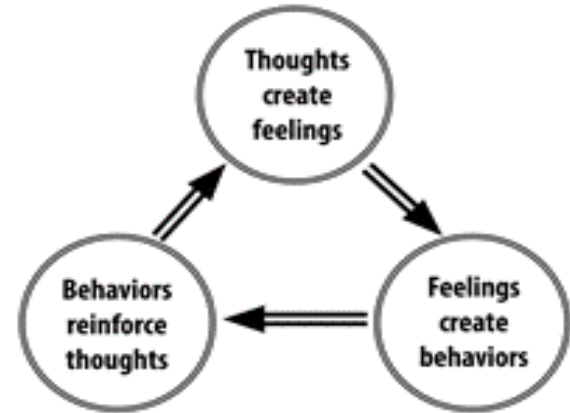


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- This model essentially helps one to check one's attitude during a period of high adversity or stress.
- It is relevant to public speaking when the speaker could analyze 'active ingredients' of an issue and then deliver upon a problem situation.



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Opting Positive Content to Deliver

- ❖ Positive communication does not always entail informative content; it can be phatic too.
- ❖ Phatic communication includes greetings and utterances such as “*nice meeting you!*”.
- ❖ It usually incorporates a constructive approach to lead a conversation, including criticism.
- ❖ Communication emulates good emotions for both the speaker and listener in an implicit manner.
- ❖ Intention, adaptation and active listening also serve as essential to establish positive communication.



Positive Thinking to Positive Talk

- Research suggests that one's personal and social well-being is essentially determined by the positive nature of their communication abilities (Albada and Moore 117).
- Communicative choices are primarily influenced by one's cognitive development.
- Research conducted by Shadinger et al. on pre-speech positive self-talk explains how employing self-affirming statements reduces performance anxiety.



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Coping Speech Anxiety through Positive Thinking

- Communication anxiety has been attributed to a variety of reasons, such as:
 1. **Skill deficits:** Lacking necessary experience and performance abilities.
 2. **Conditioning:** Past communicative experiences of negative consequences.
 3. **Cognitive:** Lack of self-awareness and complexity crisis.
- Joe Ayres, in his study elucidates the power of positive thinking to cope with speech anxiety.
- He deduces **visualisation** as an efficient tool “to reduce speech anxiety and increased the proportion of positive to negative thoughts speakers reported having before, during and after a speech.” (294)

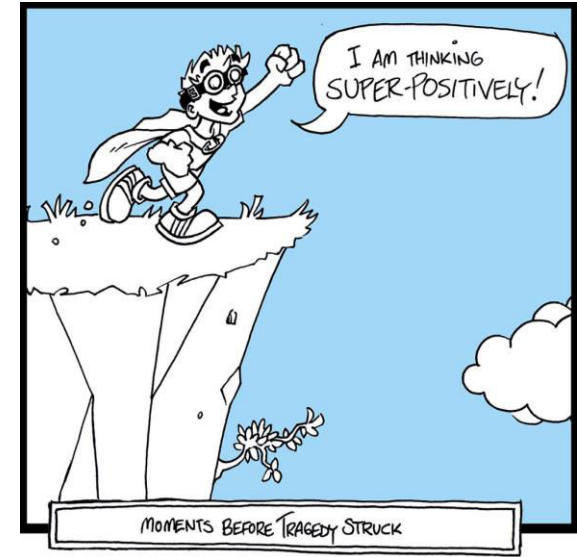
Benefits of Positive Thinking

- ❖ The ability to adapt communication with respect to the external situations and changes is an integral quality of a good public speaker.
- ❖ Scheier and Carver (28) suggested that optimists fare better in adapting to stressful situations than pessimists.
- ❖ Positive thinking as a quality is seen to be determined by categories of both nature and nurture.
- ❖ However, it is undoubtedly possible to nurture positive communication skills through practice and experience.



Limits of Positive Thinking

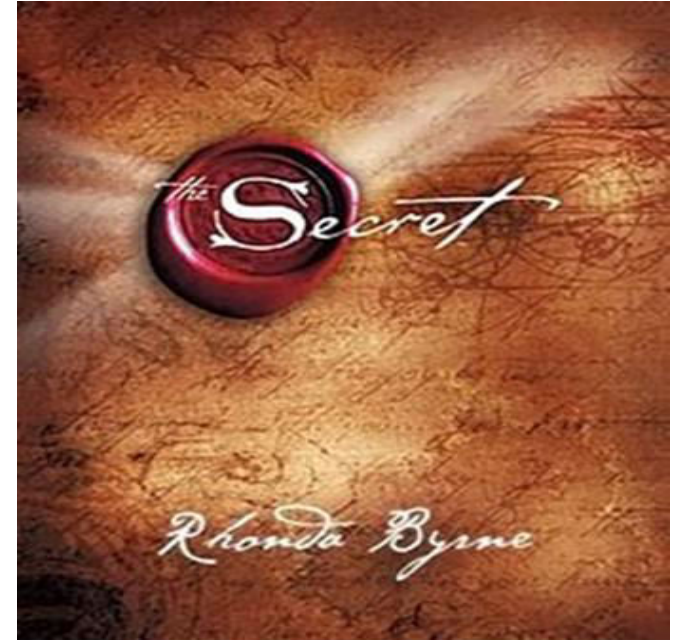
- ❖ Scheier and Carver (28-29) also notice the limitations of optimism in the cases of:
 - ❖ Unbridled optimism.
 - ❖ Maladaptive optimism
- ❖ Collinson (91) had elaborated on the tyranny of positive thinking as a cult fashion statement.
- ❖ Positive thinking, at times, can also become “disciplinary pressure and obligatory organizational practice” (Fineman, 280).



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List of Books on Positive Thinking

- ***The Power of Positive Thinking*** by [Norman Vincent Peale](#)
- ***Humankind: Changing the World One Small Act At a Time*** by [Brad Aronson](#)
- ***As a Man Thinketh*** by [James Allen](#)
- ***The Secret*** by [Rhonda Byrne](#)
- ***Think and Grow Rich*** by Napoleon Hill



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“The positive thinker sees the invisible,
feels the intangible,
and achieves the impossible.”
– Winston Churchill

Be Positive

Thank You

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